



VENUKUMAR T M

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SR. PROFESSIONAL – SCRUM | PRODUCT & PROJECT MANAGEMENT | TESTING/QA BANKING, INSURANCE, ERP, RETAIL, E-COMMERCE, TELECOM, LOGISTICS

A forward-thinking IT professional with around two decades of extensive experience in Project Management, Program Management, QA, Solution Architecture, and support execution across the globe, including Germany, the USA, Mauritius, and India. Capable of understanding and building complex systems by removing impediments and delivering customer-centric products/features. Expert in organizing and facilitating all sprint cadences (planning, reviews, retrospectives, and stand-ups). Hands-on experience in daily stand-ups, sprint planning, and sprint demos. Work closely with product owners to prepare project/program increments (large-scale planning). Practical experience in all phases of SDLC, including requirement gathering, definition, analysis, designing, development, testing, and implementation. Experienced in Sanity, Regression, Functional, System, User Interface, and Ad-hoc testing. Managed project revenues worth \$2 Bn and teams of up to 70+.

Core Competencies

Project/Program Management/Tracking | Product Management | Scrum Development Framework | Business Analysis | Requirements Elicitation | Sprint Management | Product Management | Implementation Life Cycle | Agile Development & Best Practices | CMMI Process, Documentation | Proficiency in Iterative Development | Vendor/Client Management | Delivery | SDLC | QA/QC | Process/Quality Improvement | Application Development/Enhancement | Automation/Troubleshooting | Client Communication | Internal Audits/Compliance | Risk Assessment/Management | Onshore/Offshore Coordination | Resource Management

SIGNIFICANT HIGHLIGHTS

- 50% cost savings through effective implementations, innovations, reusability, and strategy planning. Improved revenues across 80% of projects in a short span by gaining client confidence across various programs resulting in repeat business.
- Increased revenues by proposing 30+ business applications to the leadership as an investment, thereby assisting in converting potential business opportunities into large deals.
- 40% employee retention rate across all projects handled till date; led and coached teams up to 70+ resulting in reducing issues by 90%.
- Minimized escalations by setting/creating transparent work culture between the client(s) and the team through effective metrics management. 'Best Manager' award for outstanding project delivery at the Delivery Center level out of 60 projects.
- Implemented various initiatives to establish performance baselines for 70% of apps supported, reducing escalations by 80%.
- Applauded for mentoring/motivating teams in setting expectations resulting in 80% of resources being promoted to higher levels.
- Owned delivery at the client-side and delivered projects with 98.7% quality as an average from the management side. Consistently maintained the quality of 98.92% across tenure in Project Management.
- Introduced new technologies and best practices, including Big Data resulting in increased reliability and stability of the system catering to the best performance matching the growing needs of the business.
- Improved efficiency and reduced test cycle by increasing test script execution by 98%. Increased test artifact documentation by more than 97% across all applications supported.
- Improved and maintained programs & processes for quality; improved defect identification and remediation cycles by 80%.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Manager -IT, Cholamandalam MS General Insurance, Chennai, India

Apr 2023–Present

Pursuing a senior-level management to a high-performing team of 40 FTE's, bridging technology with business goals. Define IT solutions and business needs & strategies, develop, prioritize, and define end user specific and internal development processes. Oversee multiple resources in efforts towards production support, development/maintenance of the whole IT applications. Develop and implement effective delivery within the given timeline to support the sales team to achieve their sales for every month. Ensure all products meet IRDI guidelines and approve them for deployment. Implement KPI metrics, Quality metrics as well as improve efficiency.

- Handling TCS BaNCS Migration program End to End including support.
- Planning and budgeting projects/ CR's and vendor selection for the product implementation.
- Developed and implemented smoother delivery, change control, and change management procedures that improved quality.
- Set up automation framework for early finding of issues in the development life cycle.
- In alliance with infra team implementing CI / CD pipeline for the upcoming projects / CRs
- Conduct reviews with vendors as per defined KPIs and metrics.
- Ensured all teams followed development life-cycle methodology, which provided consistency in project implementation.

Test Manager, QUALITY PROFESSIONAL SERVICES, Dubai, UAE

Dec 2021–Mar 2023

Rendering senior-level management to a high-performing team of 35 for UAE's government sector, bridging technology with business goals. Define test approaches & strategies, develop, prioritize, and define customer-specific and internal development processes. Oversee multiple resources in efforts towards production support, development/maintenance of testing changes, and business-led testing. Develop and implement effective testing plans and procedures. Ensure all products meet testing and quality control standards and approve them for deployment. Implement test metrics, test automation programs to improve communication and clarity into the process, as well as improve efficiency.

- Reviewed/analyzed test plans and highlighted risks foreseen for testing and mitigated the same well in advance.
- Developed and implemented testing methodology, change control, and change management procedures that improved quality by reducing defects.
- Enhanced required integrations based on product enhancements by partnering with various integration teams.
- Evaluated product direction by engaging with business owners.
- Ensured all teams followed development life-cycle methodology, which provided consistency in project implementation.
- Coordinated migration of enhancements and fixes into higher-level environments, which improved testing accuracy.

Sr. Project Manager, IMPIGER TECHNOLOGIES, Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu, India

Feb 2020–Nov 2021

Conducted Scrum ceremonies ensuring regular updating of all scrum artifacts. Spearheaded mobile & web apps development, supporting projects, and tracking against timeline and budgets. Fully responsible for delivering application/s to client/s as per requirements and defining production support for smooth delivery. Performing Agile process implementation for all projects and defining goals for other projects under delivery. Refined high-level requirements into detailed requirements for software projects, and managed project schedules through the development life cycle.

- Single Point of Contact for all defect status-related queries and setting up of FDW program.
- Conducted workshops to share business ideas, defects, and issues with stakeholders, vendors, and development teams for effective bidding.

Program Manager (Onsite), INFOSYS LTD, India (Deputed at Commerzbank AG, Frankfurt, Germany)

Sep 2018–Jan 2020

Complete ownership of TI+ implementation in trading applications by replacing the legacy trading system. Responsible for cost estimations, automation feasibility, and POC preparation for the testing team. Defined delivery approaches & strategies; developed, prioritized, and defined customer-specific and internal processes & procedures; assessed security audit measures from the whole migration team. Oversaw test scenario/test case creation, prepared by the test team, test data setup, and guided them to ensure the test coverage. Validated all functional areas, from automation design to functional sign-off and handling automation frameworks-related responsibilities. Reviewed/analyzed results with the client team and provided daily updates; ensured quality customer deliverables and led & drove complex projects to successful completion.

- Defined/KPIs meeting guidelines, mitigated risks, and drove programs within approved budgets via strategic direction to Consulting Services; analyzed program risks and developed strategies for mitigation in collaboration with the Marketing team.
- Created technology partner engagement with leading clients catering to global markets, managed and defined processes, tools, projects, and programs for quality delivery.
- Kept workforce engaged through optimal resource utilization while maximizing client value; devised new programs and activities to achieve strategic objectives, mission, and goals of the organization.
- Formulated long-term goals, budgets, and operating plans for programs/projects. Strategically managed and implemented changes/interventions to ensure all project deliverables were achieved.
- Designed program-funding proposals to guarantee uninterrupted service delivery and developed evaluation methods to assess program strengths and identify improvement areas. FPOC for stakeholders on all project/program communication, issues, decisions, etc.

Program Manager /Scrum, SUNTRUST BANK, INFOSYS LTD, Mysore (Offshore)

Jan 2017–Sep 2018

Spearheaded all responsibilities for successful migration of Big Data Migration program as Offshore Program Manager. Worked on big data technologies, running parallel releases, and releasing high-quality enterprise software products across the organization. Involved in feasibility studies, preparing & designing business proposals, requirements analysis, conducting Scrum for all Scrum calls, and resolving queries raised by Developers in collaboration with BAs and the business team. Reviewed high-level codes, defects, and test scenarios; planned and conducted mock launches supporting weekend production deployments. Defined test strategies for projects and coordinated the work of test teams while monitoring their performance; monitored tests ensuring compliance with all company standards & policies.

- Shouldered the responsibility for successful migration of Big Data Migration program as Offshore Program Manager.
- Worked on big data technologies, running organization-wide parallel releases, and releasing high-quality enterprise software products. Developed an internal tool for end-to-end ETL testing tool Infosys Big Data Automation Program (IBAP).

- Served as Technical Delivery POC for continuous development and regular release of the testing team while creating structured processes to manage defects right through to resolution.
- Spearheaded the Agile team and provided testing estimates for every sprint; developed and maintained test methodologies.
- Executed intermediate utilities for testing requiring the least manual intervention to provide optimistic testing services to the client.
- Involved in feasibility studies, preparing & designing business proposals, requirements analysis, conducting Scrum for all Scrum calls, resolving queries raised by Developers in collaboration with BAs and the business team

Defect Manager, DEUTSCHE BANK (Onsite), Frankfurt am Main, Germany

Feb 2015–Dec 2016

End-to-end defect management responsibilities, including defect analysis, reporting, tracking and prevention, bug fixes, retesting, break fixes, impact analysis, production assurance, and system restoration. Furnished support effective lifecycle management of all defects within all development and pre-production environments. Prepared workarounds for defects considered as part of the release in line with the business; Initiated and managed the escalation process for any defects exceeding SLAs. Ensured all defects were entered correctly and controlled/managed effectively through their lifecycle.

- Single Point of Contact for all defect status-related queries and setting up of FDW program.
- Chaired daily defect/triage calls with Lead Development, Test, and Operational. Teams to provide clear minutes and actions on progress; generated and shared reports with the management.
- Collaborated with the QA/Testing and Release/Change Management teams to maintain awareness of new code changes, new test cycles, ongoing automation test results, new defects, bug fix scheduling, and retesting.

Client Solution Manager, INFOSYS LTD, Trivandrum, India

Aug 2012–Jan 2015

Managed a high-performing client solutions team, setting clear directions, enforcement of guidelines, and expected performance levels, and supervising all assigned projects. Established and maintained client relationships, client communication, report delivery, project management, and strategy development. Project managed work streams via coordination & execution of initiatives while providing testing solutions for Retail, Logistics & Banking clients. Managed the local Client Solutions team, including project workflow, enforcement of guidelines, and supervision of all assigned CST projects.

- Focal Point of Contact for automation POCs and presenting test demos to multiple clients.
- Instituted the Automation Test CoE at Infosys (offshore location) for a leading US-based Retail client.
- Enhanced client performance and expanded services via competitive estimates from the testing side to bidding deals across diverse markets.

PREVIOUS CAREER

Sr. Software Engineer, IBM, Hyderabad, India

Sep 2008–Jul 2012

Sr. QA Engineer, RISING SOLUTIONS PVT LTD, Chennai, India

May 2007–Sep 2008

Sr. Test Engineer, INDIUM SOFTWARE INDIA LTD, Chennai, India

Sep 2006–May 2007

QA Lead, EMANTRAS, Chennai, India

Nov 2005–Sep 2006

Sr. Test Engineer, VISURE TECHNOLOGIES, Hosur, India

Mar 2002–Nov 2005

EDUCATION

- **Master of Engineering (M E): Computer Science & Engineering**, Anna University, India (Pursuing)
- **Bachelor of Engineering (B E): Computer Science & Engineering**, MS University, Tirunelveli, India
- **Diploma: Computer Technology**, SA Rajas Polytechnic, Vadakkankulam, India

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- **Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO)**
- **Big Data Certified**
- **INS 21 (Insurance Domain Certification)**
- **Certified Software Test Manager (CSTM)**
- **Certified CMMI Professional**

IT SKILLS

Expertise: HP ALM, UFT, SolMan, JIRA, Bugzilla 2.20.2, C, C++, IBM MQM, SQL Server 2008, Hive, Hue, AWS S3, Redshift, VSS, SVN, Sharepoint, Test Link 1.7.2, Mantis 1.1.8, Test Track Pro, Talend Open Studio, Datastage, Cognos, SAP BO, SSIS, SSRS, Ab Initio, Windows 2000/XP/7, Unix

Testing Methodologies: Manual, Automated, Big Data, Web Services (Postman, Soap UI), ETL, BI, Database, Data Warehousing, and Product Testing, Master Test Strategies, Traceability Matrix, Automation Frameworks, Selenium, QTP Automation

Leadership Traits: Performance Parameters Definition, Results Evaluation, Capacity Enhancement, Strong Planning & Execution, Customer Focus, Risk Mitigation, Team Work & Empowerment, Innovative

Other Areas: Business Process Outsourcing, Big Data & Hadoop Migration, Business Requirement Document (BRD), Functional Requirement Specification (FRS), Defect Management, SQL Queries Review, Data - Validation, Cleansing, Verification, Identification and Mismatch, CMMi & ISO Quality Processes, Test Estimations, Proposals, Bidding Preparation, Conducting training for the team on products & processes

Elicitation Techniques: JAD sessions, Brainstorming sessions, Workshops, Experiments, Observation

Project Management: Planning, Migration, Integration, Risk, Issue, Incident & Change Management

PROJECTS AT A GLANCE

- **IBAP (Infosys Big Data Application Platform)**, SunTrust Bank, USA – Offshore Program Manager
 - **Atlas Data Lake Migration**, SunTrust Bank, USA – Offshore Program Manager
 - **Financial Data Warehousing**, Deutsche Bank, Germany – Onsite Defect Manager
 - **EPOCH OMS Implementation**, Adidas, Germany – Onsite Program Manager
 - **Data Center Migration**, TNT, Mauritius – Onsite Migration Manager
 - **Solutions Team**, Infosys, India – Client Solutions Manager
 - **UPS Logistics**, USA – Onsite Lead
 - **Kubix Stone** – Sr. Software Engineer
 - **Kosmic Music.com** – Sr. Software Engineer
 - **TK Lead Management tool** – Quality Leader
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Date of Birth: 24th May 1978 | **Nationality:** Indian | **Marital Status:** Married | **Passport:** M6777709

Please refer to Annexure for key projects handled and other details...